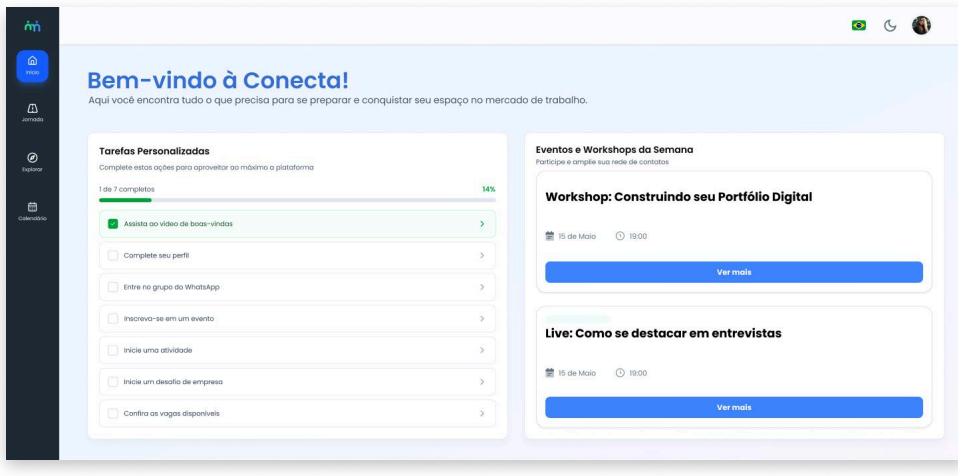


Networkme Conecta

Repositioning a paid product from polish to progression.



CONTEXT

Networkme —
Conecta
(paid product)

DURATION

10 weeks
end-to-end

ROLE

Solo Product
Designer

STATUS

Shipped
Measured in
production

THE THESIS

Conecta didn't
lack polish.

It lacked a place
to stand.

*Premium isn't perceived through visuals.
It's perceived through progression.*

POST-RELEASE

+28% onboarding completion
+41% first-session actions completed
-32% time to first action
+18% 7-day retention

The CEO asked for refinement. Users asked for **direction**.

Conecta felt like an extension of the free platform. The premium product didn't feel like a new experience.

THE CEO'S BRIEF

More refinement.

More perceived value.

A more premium experience.

THE SHIFT

From polish → to progression.

The focus moved from appearance
to creating a clear path forward.

THE REFRAME

The problem wasn't visual. It was structural. Users didn't know where they were, what to do next, or how to move forward.

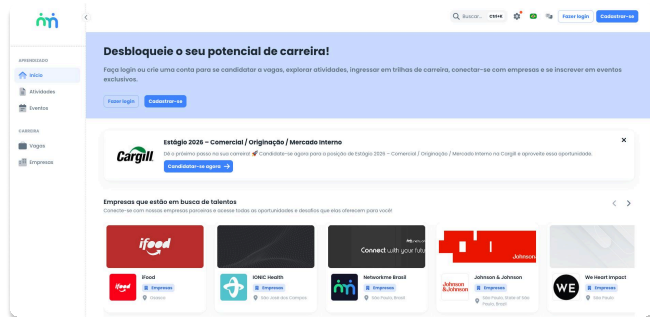
Two products. One experience.

Conecta inherited the free plan's structure. Users couldn't feel what they were paying for.

NETWORKME — FREE

Discovery marketplace

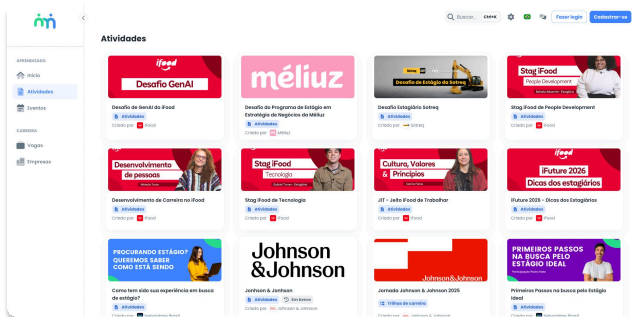
- Content-driven navigation
- Exploration-first experience
- No clear progression



CONECTA — PAID

Premium without a premium architecture

- Same navigation
- Same discovery model
- No visible journey or progress



THE DIAGNOSIS

The problem wasn't missing features. It was missing architecture to support the premium value.

The pattern was a loop, not a gap.

Multiple sources revealed the same behavior: users explored, but didn't move forward.

METHODS

- Product analytics (Mixpanel)
- Sessions with paying users
- JTBD workshop with stakeholders

WHAT WE FOUND

01 — Lack of direction

Users started by exploring, not acting.
The dashboard offered options, not a path.

02 — Invisible progress

Users couldn't tell what they had completed or
what came next.

03 — Content without hierarchy

Workshops, jobs, and activities
competed for attention.

THE INSIGHT

Explore → consider
→ hesitate → explore again

The problem wasn't lack of content.
It was lack of a journey.

Activation is not a feature. It is the **foundation** the product is built on.

BEFORE — V1 MENTAL MODEL

Conecta = content destinations

Workshops, jobs, and events were isolated destinations.
Users had to build their own path.

AFTER — V2 ARCHITECTURE

Activation = structured journey

Onboarding defines intent.
Dashboard guides action.
The journey makes progress visible.

WHY THIS BET HELD

Before: competing on content volume.

After: competing on user return.

We chose retention.

A repositioning doesn't happen by itself.

The CEO wanted refinement. Product wanted new features. Engineering had constraints.

A 2-day workshop aligned the problem before the solution.

DAY 1 — OPPORTUNITY DEFINITION

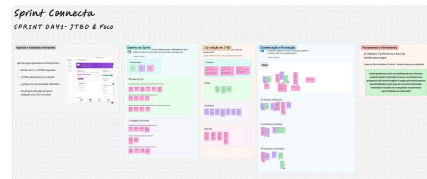
- JTBD mapping
- Opportunity prioritization
- Alignment on the activation challenge

Outcome: shared understanding of the problem.

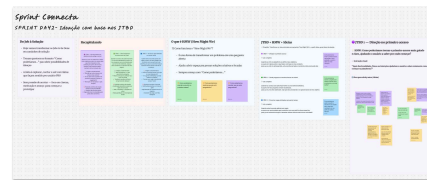
DAY 2 — FROM JOBS TO SOLUTIONS

- Collaborative ideation
- Impact × Effort matrix
- Feasibility validation with engineering

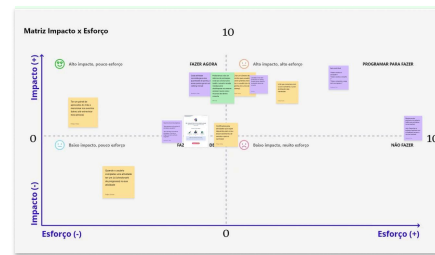
Outcome: prioritized solutions ready for prototyping.



Day 1 — Opportunity Definition



Day 2 — Solution Framing



Prioritization Matrix (Impact vs Effort)

WHO PARTICIPATED

CEO · Product Manager · Tech Lead · Product Designer (me). The workshop was the moment the brief changed — collectively.

Two cuts. One reason.

Instead of investing in premium perception, I prioritized the architecture of progression.

CUT 01 — VISUAL REDESIGN

**I rejected a visual refresh
without structural change.**

The visual system already worked.
The problem was the lack of progression.

Trade-off: less immediate visual impact,
more long-term value.

CUT 02 — PROFILE PERSONALIZATION

**I delivered one journey instead
of three experiences.**

Research revealed different user profiles,
but personalization without activation
would be premature.

Trade-off: less initial variation, more
journey clarity.

THE LOGIC

**Activation first.
Everything else comes after.**

*Senior design isn't about
delivering everything requested.*

*It's about prioritizing what
changes the product.*

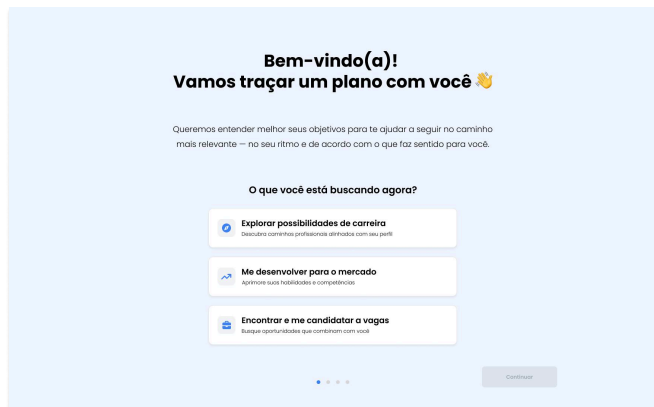
Four surfaces. One foundation.

Users learn the model once and apply it everywhere.

01 ONBOARDING

Define the intent

Reduce initial hesitation.

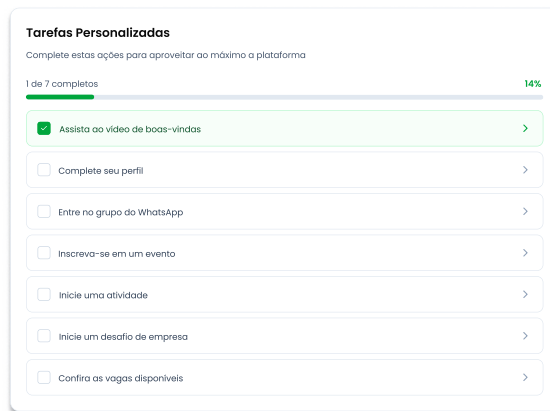


- Ask about the goal, not preferences
- Provide contextual examples for each option
- Result: a personalized plan

02 DASHBOARD

Prioritize action

Replace the static homepage with momentum.



- Personalized, prioritized task list
- Visible progress bar
- Next best action prioritized

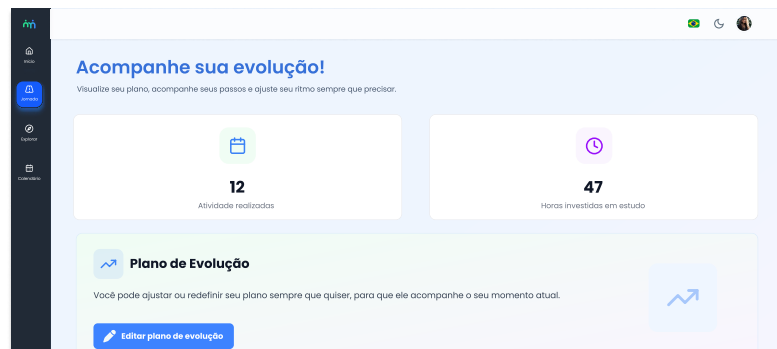
Four surfaces. One foundation.

Users learn the model once and apply it everywhere.

03 JOURNEY

Make progress visible

Turn growth into something measurable.

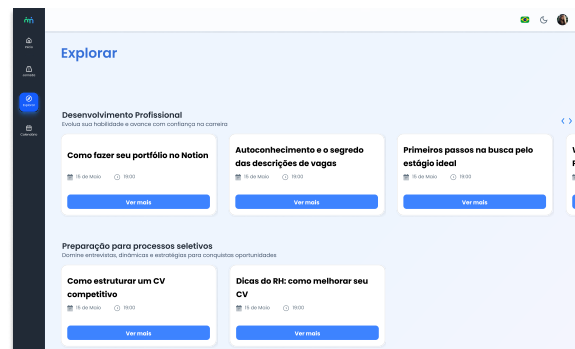


- Completed activities, hours invested
- Editable growth plan
- Achievements and certifications

04 EXPLORE

Preserve autonomy

Free exploration — without overload.



- Free exploration stays separate
- Categorized, not presented as a feed
- Never competes with the guided path

Three profiles. One system that needs to work for everyone.

The profiles weren't segments. They were stress tests for the system.

01 - THE EXPLORER

"I'm still figuring out my path."

Needs: clarity to get started.

Test: does the journey guide users who don't know the next step?

Result: onboarding creates direction without pressure.

02 - THE BUILDER

"I'm building my next step."

Needs: visible progress.

Test: can the product support continuous growth?

Result: tasks and activities become measurable progress.

03 - THE ACHIEVER

"I'm turning my path into achievements."

Needs: high-value actions.

Test: does the product stay relevant for users who already have clarity?

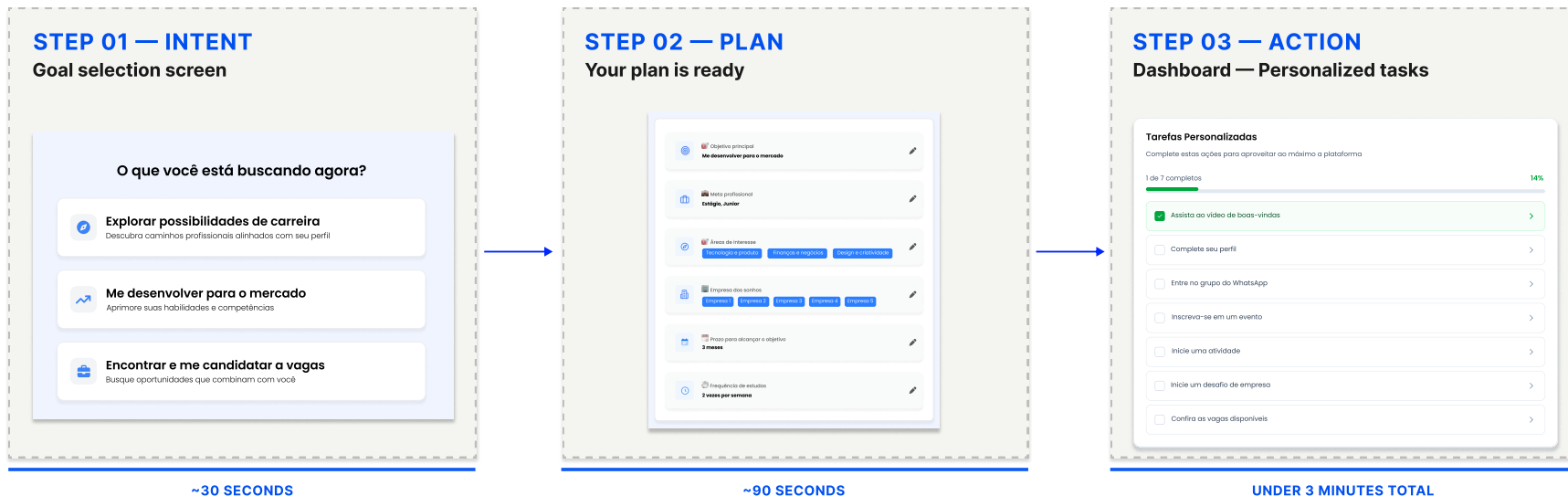
Result: focus on opportunities, resumes, and applications.

PRINCIPLE

Different profiles revealed the same challenge: a clear journey. V1 delivers one core experience. Personalization comes after activation.

From intent to the next action in under three minutes.

The onboarding identifies the user's goal and turns intent into a clear journey.



WHY IT WORKS

Intent before information (Insight 1)

- One question gives the user direction.
- Examples reduce the initial barrier.

WHY IT WORKS

The plan becomes progress (Insight 2)

- Intent turns into next steps.
- The user understands where they are and what to do.

WHY IT WORKS

Action before discovery (Insight 3)

- The next best action appears first.
- Features are organized around the journey.

Four insights. Four pattern changes.

What usability testing taught us.

01 Hesitation when defining the goal

Users hesitated when choosing their main goal during onboarding.

→ Added contextual examples and clearer framing of the outcome.

02 Confusion when prioritizing tasks

Users struggled to identify the next best action on the dashboard.

→ Introduced stronger visual hierarchy and sequence indicators.

03 Visible progress increased engagement

Users responded positively to visible progress tracking.

→ Strengthened progress indicators across the dashboard and journey.

04 Mixed navigation created overload

Users felt overwhelmed when structured tasks and free exploration shared the same surface.

→ Reinforced the separation between the guided path and exploration.

I shipped knowing two questions were still open.

Senior judgment isn't about delivering something perfect.

It's about knowing which imperfections are safe to ship—and which would invalidate the bet.

TRADE-OFF 01

Profile-based personalization was deferred, not designed.

The three profiles informed the system, but don't change it yet. Today, an Achiever and an Explorer see the same dashboard ordering.

WHY I SHIPPED ANYWAY - Personalizing before activation was proven would be premature optimization.

TRADE-OFF 02

Long-term retention remains an open question.

7-day retention increased by +18%. The 30- and 90-day cohorts are still maturing. The next question is whether the foundation compounds over months—not weeks.

WHY I SHIPPED ANYWAY - Holding the launch to observe long-term cohorts would have delayed the product by months. The early signal supports the bet.

Every number validates a decision.

Activation and engagement metrics from Mixpanel, 8 weeks after launch.

+28%

Onboarding completion
(54% → 69%)

+41%

Task completion in the
first session
(≥3 checklist actions)

-32%

Time to first
meaningful action
(18 min → 12 min)

+18%

7-day retention
(active users)
(33% → 39%)

WHAT THIS TAUGHT ME

**Activation didn't come from adding more features.
It came from creating a clear journey.**

The role of a senior designer is to make choices
that make the rest of the product stronger.

WHAT I'D REVISIT

- Profile-based personalization after validating long-term retention
- Behavior-based adaptive progression
- Visual refresh after consolidating the architecture

EXPLORE THE PROTOTYPE

[Figma prototype link](#)

Thanks for reading.